

JSS 1 ISLAMIC RELIGIOUS STUDIES – FIRST TERM

TOPIC 3: QUR'ANIC RECITATION – SURATUL BURUJ (Q85:1–22)

Surah Al-Buruj (The Constellations / The Mansions of the Stars)

1. Introduction to the Surah

Surah Al-Buruj is the **85th chapter** of the Qur'an. It is a **Makki Surah** with **22 verses**. The name 'Al-Buruj' means 'The Constellations' or 'The Mansions of the Stars'. It belongs to Juz 30.

2. Full Text with English Translation (Summary of Key Verses)

Bismillahir-Rahmanir-Rahim

1. By the sky containing great stars (constellations),
2. And by the promised Day (of Judgment),
3. And by the witness and what is witnessed,
4. Cursed were the companions of the trench (Ashab al-Ukhdud),
5. The fire full of fuel,
6. When they were sitting near it,
7. And they were witnesses to what they were doing to the believers.
8. They resented them only because they believed in Allah, the Exalted in Might, the Praiseworthy,
9. To Whom belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth. And Allah is Witness over all things.
10. Indeed, those who persecute the believing men and believing women and then do not repent will have the punishment of Hell, and they will have the punishment of the Burning Fire.
11. Indeed, those who believe and do righteous deeds will have gardens beneath which rivers flow. That is the great success.
12. Indeed, the grip (punishment) of your Lord is severe.
- 13–16. It is He Who originates and repeats (creation). And He is the Forgiving, the Affectionate, Owner of the Throne, the Glorious, Doer of what He wills.
- 17–18. Has there come to you the story of the soldiers – of Pharaoh and Thamud?
- 19–20. But those who disbelieve are in denial, while Allah encompasses them from behind.
- 21–22. But this is a glorious Qur'an, in a Preserved Tablet (Lawh Mahfuz).

3. Explanation – The Story of the People of the Trench

The Surah mentions the story of the **People of the Trench (Ashab al-Ukhdud)**. They were a group of tyrants who dug a large trench, filled it with fire, and threw believing men and women into it simply because they believed in Allah. These oppressors sat by and watched the believers burn. Allah curses them and warns that those who persecute believers and do not repent will face severe punishment in Hell.

In contrast, those who believe and do good deeds will enter Paradise – the greatest success. The Surah also reminds us of the destruction of Pharaoh and the people of Thamud as examples of Allah's justice.

4. Lessons from Suratul Buruj

- True believers may face trials, persecution, and hardship for their faith.
- Oppression and cruelty against believers is a grave sin that Allah will punish severely.
- Patience and steadfastness (Sabr) in the face of trials lead to great reward in Paradise.

- Allah is both Most Forgiving (to those who repent) and Most Powerful in punishment.
- Allah is the Owner of the heavens and the earth and is a Witness over everything.
- The Qur'an is a glorious Book preserved in the Lawh Mahfuz (Preserved Tablet).
- History shows that tyrants (like Pharaoh) are eventually destroyed by Allah.

5. Key Themes

- Persecution of believers and Allah's justice
- Reward for the patient and punishment for the oppressors
- The power and mercy of Allah
- The preservation and glory of the Qur'an

End of Topic 3 – Suratul Buruj